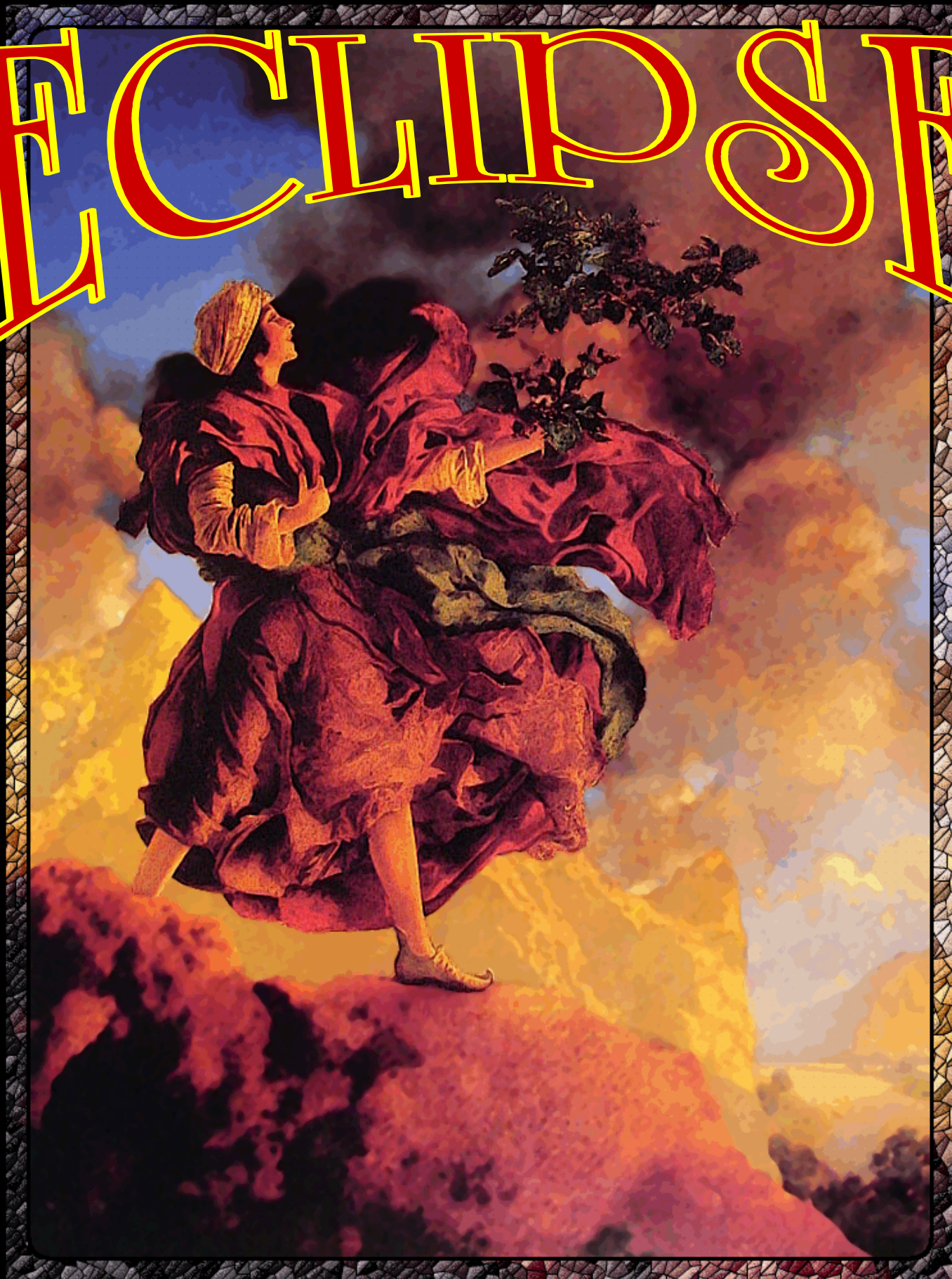


THE ULTIMATE D20 POINT BUY

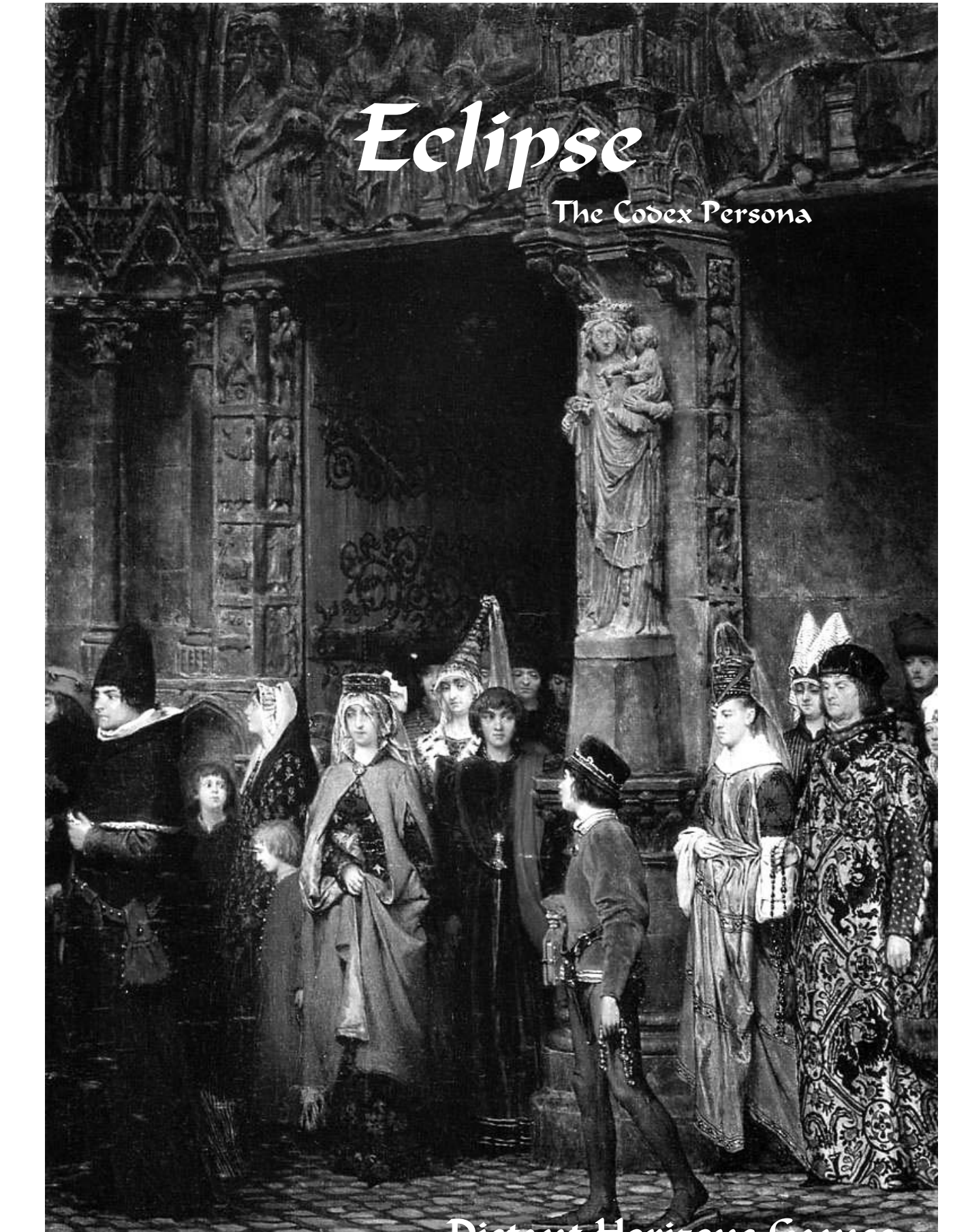
ECLIPSE



THE *CODEX PERSONA*

DHG 1007

A *DISTANT HORIZONS GAMES* PRODUCT



Eclipse

The Codex Persona

Distant Horizons Games



DISTANT HORIZONS



WWW.DISTANTHORIZONGAMES.COM

Eclipse : The Codex Persona

A *Distant Horizons Games* product by Paul Melroy and Patrick "Stanley" Bryant.

Cover Art from Princess Parizade Bringing Home the Singing Tree by Maxfield Parrish, 1906.

Copyright © 2005 by Paul Melroy. ISBN 978-1-4303-0313-8

Distant Horizons Games Logo trademark *Distant Horizons Games*.

The following items are hereby designated as Product Identity in accordance with section 1(e) of the Open Game License, version 1.0a: The *Introduction* and *How do I use this product* section, the explanatory text under *Corrupted and Specialized Magic*, the *Control Mechanisms* section other than the *Adventurer Framework*, the *Disadvantage Descriptions*, the *Pacts*, *Types of Witches*, and *Power Sources and Witches* sections, the *Characters* section of Chapter Five, the *Chakra* section, and the *Epic Monsters* section outside of the game statistics. Descriptive material other than game mechanics, including captions, invented "quotations", and elements of game setting, including but not limited to, capitalized names, names of artifacts, spell names, characters, countries, creatures, geographic locations, gods, historic events, lands, magic items, organizations, secret societies, legends, and original storylines. The product identity listed above is not Open Game Content. Permission is hereby granted to refer back to this book when presenting characters in point-buy format in other products.

'd20 System' and the 'd20 System' logo are trademarks of Wizards of the Coast, Inc. and are used according to the terms of the d20 System License version 6.0. A copy of this License can be found at www.wizards.com/d20.

Wizards of the Coast is a trademark of Wizards of the Coast, Inc. in the United States and other countries and is used with permission.

Questions? Comments? Errata? Something you'd like to see in the next supplement? Contact us at Feedback@DistantHorizonsGames.Com



ECLIPSE: THE CODEX PERSONA

What's all this about?

Well, reviews are good, but publicity is nil, so we're releasing the .PDF version of *Eclipse: The Codex Persona* as Shareware: If you like it, please drop by and pay for it (or buy the print edition at Lulu.Com) and get on our list for the fourth edition update once Wizards of the Coast releases the 4'th edition SRD.

Pay for the PDF at Lulu.Com

Pay for the PDF at RPGNow.Com

Buy the Direct Print Edition at Lulu.Com

Or - if you want to give us a little extra money -

Buy the Distribution Edition at Lulu.Com

This page does not appear in either print version; the only real difference in the editions is in the covers - and in not having to compensate for the distributors cut.

Questions, comments, suggestions, and requests are probably best left at my gaming blog, at <http://ruscumag.wordpress.com/>. If there are very many, I'll put up a FAQ or two in the d20 tab. There are some other files and sample characters available there as well.

If you want hard copies of some of our other books, they're also available through our Lulu Storefront.

Happy Gaming!



Welcome To

Eclipse

The Codex Persona

The Ultimate d20 Character Guide

Or, the World's Longest Character Class

Hello!

You're probably suffering from a case of sourcebook overload. Even the official products have started listing prestige classes so esoteric that they probably only have one or two members. Feat, class, and prestige class information is scattered over dozens of volumes - and you'll often still find it difficult or impossible to build the character you want.

And isn't that the point?

Eclipse is designed to solve that. It's designed to put every special power and exotic ability into one book and one pay-as-you-go class system. You can design just the characters you want. You can throw out all of those weird classes, abusive builds, and peculiar special cases while tailoring the available abilities to fit your world. Secondly, it includes an enormous number of brand new abilities, as well as several entirely new magic systems. Hopefully, *Eclipse* will spark your imagination and help you see rules and variants more clearly.

We're writing *Eclipse* so that characters can be reliably translated in mid-game regardless of which basic set of d20 rules you're using. You can even mix and match between Modern, Future, 3.0, 3.5, and many more. For example, *Eclipse* doesn't need a comprehensive cybernetics system, because *Eclipse* is a point-based system. Characters can have all the cyberware they want, but this amounts to purchasing particular abilities. Similarly, *Eclipse* allows play under many different wealth systems. One can even ignore money, using feats instead. We call *Eclipse* the *ultimate* for a reason.

We have a way to build every power or ability we've ever seen. With this product, you might want to look at other books for a references or ideas, but you need nothing except the d20 core rulebooks, dice, paper, and a pencil.

Eclipse requires more GM interpretation and rulings than other systems because it aims to be exceptionally versatile. To make your GM experience easier, it also contains ways to bring the players in on the task of world creation. It may be your game - but why should you do all the work?



How Do I Use This Product?

In one sense, this is merely another big book o' powers. In another sense, *Eclipse* stands to redefine how people create, develop, and play in d20 campaigns. *Distant Horizons Games* is committed to bringing you quality products – products that are comprehensive, organized, and versatile. We can't possibly anticipate or prepare material for every game, so instead we've made the familiar d20 system become much more flexible and alive, responding to your every whim.

We've play-tested, pushed, prodded, and pulled every corner of this system. And it works. None of our players are willing to play d20 with any other system anymore - and we think it would be cruel to try and make them.

As a Game Master, you don't need to learn every variation, but remember that flexibility is the goal. Every power we've ever seen in a d20 product is in here, along with hundreds we came up with ourselves, stripped down to their basic principles. If someone wants to create a weird variant on something, let them. There's no reason a strange variant on an ability is necessarily more powerful than an everyday one; it's just strange.

Some people are going to look at this and say, "Horrors! This makes power-gaming too easy!" Yes, any versatile system will. But we're espousing RPG heresy here and saying in reply, "So?"

You're running the universe. Their characters aren't going to get any bigger than that. If the players insist on adding another zero after everything, just give more dramatic descriptions and do the same. Remember that your job is to challenge them, not to fight them.

Now if it's just a few of them you may have to haul out some of our player-control options - or just tell them "No."

Are they finding ways you never thought of to deal with monsters without fighting? Applaud them and reward them and make bigger, more dangerous challenges for their minds! There's nothing you can't do if you just put your mind to it.

If the players take powers that totally shatter the illusion of reality you were trying to create, you do have a problem. But if you wanted to run a grim-and-gritty Rogue-oriented game and they all took *Fireball*-spewing Wizards, the problem isn't in the game system.

As a player, you need to learn how to play responsibly if you don't already know how. Don't count on the Game Master to sit there and keep you in check; he or she has better things to do than babysit. Besides, this is supposed to be fun, not fighting. Ask your Game Master what kind of character and level of ability is appropriate to the world you're playing in.

If your Game Master sets unreasonable expectations, you have several options. The first and most preferable is to convince (not nag!) him or her to see things your way. If that fails, try to work out an experimental deal. If that fails, you can always start your own game and do it the way you wanted to. Your Game Master could probably use a break anyway; does he or she ever get to play?

General Index

Introduction	1
How Do I Use This Product?	2
Index	3
Definitions	6

Chapter 1: Getting Started

<i>System Introduction</i>	8
Describing your personal class	
"But I'm playing in character!"	8
Character Building Basics	9
Children, Growth, and Adventurers	9
<i>Basic Expenditures</i>	9
Hit Dice	9
Skills	9
General Skill Options	10
3d6 Checks	10
Familiarities	10
Learn as you go	10
Basic Skills	10
Specific Knowledges	10
True Names	10
Saving Throws	10
Special Abilities	10
Proficiencies	10
Base Attack Bonus	10
Base Caster Level	10
Magic Levels	11
Limitations	11
Clerical Magic Package	11
Spells	11
<i>Spell Progression Tables</i>	12
Paladin and Ranger	12
3.0 Psychic Warrior	12
Psychic Spellcasting	12
3.5 Psychic Warrior	12
Wilder	12
Phantom Slot Option	12
Adept	13
Bard	13
Cleric and Druid	13
3.0 Psion	14
3.5 Psion	14
Wizard	14
Sorcerer	14
Corrupted and Specialized Magic	
Destructive	15
Difficult	15
Elemental	15
Focused	15
Granted	15
Mysticism	15
Ritualist	15
Subsumption	15
Unreliable	15
Wild	15
<i>Control Mechanisms</i>	16
Bloodlines	16
Ritual	16

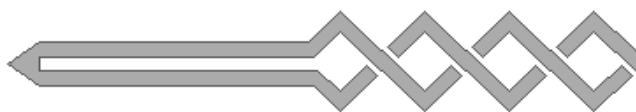
Secrets	16
Training	16
Development	16
Approval	16
Framework	16
The Generic Adventurer	16
<i>Per Level Modifiers</i>	17
Dabbler	17
Duties	17
Fast Learner	17
Restrictions	17
Untrained	17
Very Limited Spell List	17
NPC Levels	18
<i>Once-Off CP Bonuses</i>	18
Package Deals	18
Retraining	18
Unique Training	18
Disadvantages	18
<i>Disadvantage List</i>	18
Accursed	18
Aged	18
Blocked	18
Broke	18
Compulsive	18
Dependent	18
Foolish	19
Frail	19
Hallucinations	19
Healing Resistant	19
History	19
Hunted	19
Illiterate	19
Incompetent	19
Inept	19
Insane	19
Irreverent	19
Obligations	19
Outcast	19
Poor Reputation	19
Recorder	19
Secret	19
Showman	20
Slow	20
Stigmata	20
Unarmoured	20
Uncivilized	20
Unluck	20
Untrustworthy	20
Valuable	20
Vows	20
Handling Disadvantages	20

Chapter 2: Special Abilities

<i>Ability Modifiers</i>	22
Corrupted	22
Al. Hedge Magician	22
Specialized	22
Bonus Uses	22
<i>Basic Abilities</i>	23
Reading The Entries	23
Extraordinary, Spell-Like,	
And Supernatural	23

Ability Focus	23
Acrobatics	23
Action Hero	23
Heroism	23
Stunts	24
Crafting	24
Invention	24
Influence	24
Adaptation	24
Adept	24
Ambidexterity	24
Assistant	24
Augmented Bonus	25
Augmented Magic	25
Awareness	25
Berserker	25
Blessing	26
Blood Curse	26
Body Fuel	26
Celerity	27
Cloaking	27
Companion	27
Contacts	28
Countermagic	28
Costly	28
Create Artifact	28
Create Item	29
Create Relic	29
Damage Reduction	29
Deep Sleep	30
Device Use	30
Domain/Path	30
Metaspells	30
Dominion*	31
Dweomer*	31
Eldritch	31
Empowerment	31
Enthusiast	31
Equipage	31
Executive	31
Expertise	32
Favors	32
Finesse	32
Grant of Aid	32
Fast Healing and	
Regeneration	32
"Unlimited" Abilities	32
Guises	33
Harnessed Intellect	33
Healing Touch	33
Hysteria	33
Inherent Spell	33
Immunity	34
Innate Enchantment	34
Innate Magic	35
Invocation	35
Jack-of-All Trades	35
Journeyman	35
Karma	35
Leadership	35
Lore	36
Luck	36
Mana	36
Mastery	37
Melding	37





Mentor	37
Mindspeech	37
Mystic Artist*	38
Mystic Link	38
Occult Sense	38
Occult Skill	38
Restricted Skills	39
Shadow Walk	39
Occult Talent	39
Opportunist	39
Poison Use	39
Power Words	39
Presence	39
Privilege	40
Professional	40
Reflex Training	40
Reputation	40
Researcher	41
Resist	41
Returning	41
Rider	41
Rite of Chi	42
Sanctum	42
Schooling	42
Self-Development	42
Shadowmaster	42
Shapeshift	42
Shaping*	43
Siddhis yoga	44
Skill Emphasis	44
Skill Focus	44
Snatch	44
Specialist	44
Spell Conversion	44
Spell Flow	44
Spell Mastery	45
Spell Pool	45
Spell/Power Resistance	45
Spell Shorthand	45
Spell Storing*	45
Spell Turning	45
Stoic	45
Superstition	46
Test of Wills	46
Thaumaturgy*	46
Theurgy*	46
Timeless Body	46
Tireless	47
Toughness	47
Traceless	47
Track	47
Travel	48
Triggering	48
Turn Resistance	48
Unity	48
Wayfarer	48
Witchcraft*	48
Workhorse	48

* These are gateway abilities. Full descriptions appear in Chapter 3

<i>Proficiencies</i>	49
Armor	49
Weapon	49

<i>Combat Enhancements</i>	50
Anime Master	50
Augment Attack	50
Blind-Fight	50
Block	50
Bonus Attack	51
Chain of Ki	51
Defender	51
Doubled Damage	51
Enhanced Strike	51
Evasive	52
Far Shot	52
Favored Enemy	52
Favored Foe	52
Favored Enemy/Foe Types	52
Variants	52
Fortune	53
Imbuement	53
Improved Critical	53
Improved Initiative	53
Improvise Weapon	53
Legionary	53
Lunge	53
Maneuver	53
Martial Arts	53
Occult Combat	54
Overwhelm	54
Rapid Strike	54
Smite	54
Specialist	54
Spirit Weapon	55
Split Movement	55
Throwing Master	55
Trick	55
<i>Metamagical Theorems</i>	56
Metapsionic Equivalency	56
The Theorems	56
Amplify	56
Area	56
Battle Magic	57
Compact	57
Easy	57
Elemental Manipulation	58
Extension	58
Lacing	58
Multiple	59
Persistent	59
Sculpting	59
Stabilize	59
Transference	59
Triggering	60
<i>Metamagical Upgrades</i>	60
Glory	60
Streamline	60
Fast	60
<i>Templates and Racial Abilities</i>	61
ECL Adjustments	61
Racial Abilities	61
Amorphous	61
Attribute Shift	61
Energy Infusion	61
Extra Limbs	61
Non-Abilities	61

Size Modifications	62
Extended Size Chart	62
Growth	62
Shrinking	62
General Notes	63
Existing Templates	63
Half-Celestial	63
Half-Dragon	63
Half-Fiend	63
Afflicted Lycanthrope	63
Natural Lycanthrope	64
Variant Lycanthropes	64
Minor Monster Powers	64
Chapter 3: Paths and Powers	65
<i>Channeling</i>	66
Basic Factors	66
General Enhancements	67
Censure	68
Conversion	68
Damaging	68
Divine Command	68
Dualism	68
Great Channeling	68
Heightened	68
Sacred Hand	68
Glorious Touch Path	68
Hatred's Weal Path	69
Hand of Darkness Path	69
Planar Bonds Path	69
Path of Infusions	70
Divine Wrath Path	70
Tides of Light and Darkness	71
Boundless Realms Path	71
<i>Dominion and Divine Ascension</i>	72
Gaining Dominion	72
Personal Dominion	72
Political Dominion	72
Advanced Dominion	73
The Way of the Lands	73
The Way of Omnipresence	73
The Way of Valour	74
Wrath of the Overlord	74
The Path of the Pharaoh	75
Godfire	76
Gaining Godfire	76
Optional Rules	77
Using Godfire	77
Side Effects of Godfire	78
PC's, NPC's and Godfire	78
<i>Hexcraft</i>	79
Creating Hexes	79
Buying Hexcrafting	79
Assigning Spell Levels	79
Importing Spell Lists	80
World Laws	80
<i>Martial Arts</i>	80
[Martial Art], the Skill	80
Basic Abilities	81
Advanced Techniques	81



Master and Occult Techniques	82	<i>Thaumaturgy and Dweomer</i>	100	Chapter 4: High-Level Magic	122
Sample Martial Arts Skills	83	Weaving Effects	100	<i>Spell Key</i>	123
Adamantine Fist	83	Basic DC and Cost	101	<i>The Spells</i>	124
Arctic Fire Kung Fu	83	DC Modifiers	101	Tenth Level Spells	124
Crane Style Kung Fu	83	Cost Modifiers	102	Eleventh Level Spells	127
Wind Dance	83	Special Benefits	102	Twelfth Level Spells	128
Cloak Mastery	83	Special Options	102	Thirteenth Level Spells	132
Oaken Storm	83	Thaumaturgy Sample Fields:	103	Fourteenth Level Spells	135
Phantom Blade	84	Necromancy	103	Fifteenth Level Spells	137
Gungnir's Flight Kung Fu	84	Weather Control	103	Sixteenth Level Spells	139
Blood Blade Technique	84	Dweomer Sample Fields:	104	Seventeenth Level Spells	141
Ghost Busting Technique	84	Psychokinesis	104	Eighteenth Level Spells	143
		Telepathy	104	Nineteenth Level Spells	144
<i>Mystic Artist</i>	84	Other Dweomer Fields	105	Twentieth Level Spells	146
Basic Abilities	85	Warping	105	Twenty-First Level Spells	147
Inspiration Abilities	85	Healing	105	Twenty-Second L. Spells	149
Positive Levels	86	Extra-Sensory Per.	106	Twenty-Third L. Spells	150
Manipulation Abilities	86	Mysticism	106	Twenty-Fourth L. Spells	151
Synergy Abilities	86	Practical Consideration	106		
The Classical Bard	87				
Basic Ability Modifiers	87	<i>Theurgy</i>	107	Chapter 5: Building a Campaign	152
Amplification	87	Theurgical Verbs	107	<i>Characters</i>	153
Echoes	87	Theurgical Nouns	107	Personality Traits	153
Enduring	87	The Physical Elements	107	Granted Powers	154
Great Projection	87	The Living Elements	108	Motivations	155
Projection	87	The Hidden Elements	108	Character Profiles	156
Rapid	87	Sample Theurgical Effects	108	The Questions	156
Seeking	87	Customizing Theurgy	108	Interpreting the Results	158
Whispers	87			Descriptions	159
Enhanced Abilities	88	<i>Witchcraft</i>	109	<i>World Construction</i>	160
Path of Artistic Mastery	88	Basic Abilities	110	Sample World Templates	160
Path of Whispers	89	The Adamant Will	110	Putting Players to Work	162
Chords of Fate	89	Dreamfaring	110	Keeping Characters	
The Celebrated Way	90	Elfshot	110	Under Control	163
Path of Dissonance	90	Glamour	110	Sample Character Builds	164
Art of the Occult	91	Hand Of Shadows	110		
		Healing	110		
<i>The Path of the Dragon</i>	92	Hyloka	110	<i>Templates</i>	167
The Way of the Artificer	92	Infliction	110	The Faithful Steed	167
The Way of Inner Fire	93	The Inner Eye	110	Nature Spirit	168
The W. of Hosting the Essence	94	Shadowweave	110	Realm Spirit	169
The W. of the Wings of Fire	94	Witchfire	110		
The W. of the Dragon's Speech	95	Witchsight	110	<i>Epic Monsters</i>	170
The Way of the Dragon's Craft	95				
		Pacts	111	Appendix 1: Chakra	173
<i>Ritual Magic</i>	96	Service	111	Appendix 2: Class Breakdowns	176
Occult Ritual	96	Vow	111	<i>Standard Adventurer Classes</i>	176
Weird Science	96	Sacrifice	112	<i>Non-Adventurer/NPC Classes</i>	182
Ritual Results	96	Infusion	112	<i>Prestige Classes</i>	183
		Energy	112	<i>d20 Modern Base Classes</i>	188
<i>Rune Magic</i>	97	Types of Witches	113	<i>Companion Bonuses</i>	189
Rune Casting	97	Power Sources and Witches	114	<i>Using Other DHG Products</i>	189
Rune Mastery	97	Spirit Types	114	Appendix 3: 3.5 Feat Conversion	190
Minor Abilities	97	Advanced Witchcraft	115	Quick NPC Conversions	190
Magician	97	Path of Coven Mastery	115	<i>Afterword</i>	191
Runic Ritual	97	Path of Spirits	116		
		Path of Darkness	117	<i>Art Credits</i>	192
<i>Spell Storing</i>	98	Path of Water	118	<i>Product Identity</i>	192
Improved Activation	98	Path of Earth	119	<i>Open Game License</i>	193
Multiple Embedment	98	Path of Fire	119	<i>Other Products</i>	194
Additional Media	99	Path of Air	120		
Maximum Level Increase	99	Path of Light	121	<i>Character Persona Worksheet</i>	195
Multiple Formula	99			<i>Campaign Option Checklist</i>	197
Focusing	99				



Definitions

- **Base Caster Level:** An option for buying Caster Level independently of spell slots.
- **Basic Skills:** An option for giving each character a minimum cultural skill package.
- **(Cha Mod):** Charisma Bonus. Abbreviation.
- **Channeling:** The use of positive or negative energy.
- **Class:** A character's personal description of what he or she does and how he or she does it.
- **Corrupted:** A fairly specific ability. *When capitalized, it refers to a feat modifier noted on page 22!*
- **(Con Mod):** Constitution Bonus. Abbreviation.
- **Chakra:** Personal magical power nexi, an in-game system for limiting power combinations.
- **Character Points (CP):** Character points granted by levels are used to build characters or creatures.

- **(Dex Mod):** Dexterity Bonus. Abbreviation.
- **Disadvantages:** Special character limitations which provide a (modest) number of extra CP when taken.
- **Dominion:** Gathering power from the support of your followers.
- **Dweomer:** A scientific spellcasting technique using specific magical skills.
- **Familiarities:** An option for making skills more important by penalizing unskilled characters.
- **Framework:** Character construction guidelines for a specific campaign.
- **GM:** Game Master: The Game Master creates a plot or adventure for the players.
- **GMO:** Game Master's Option: the GM can decide what to do with or to the party. This one doesn't get used much in this product, but we commonly use it in other *Distant Horizons Games* books.
- **Generic Spell Levels:** These are spell levels which are not bound to a specific spell. Spontaneous casters can use them to restore expended

spell levels (on a 1-for-1 basis). Other casters can not. Some abilities are fueled with Generic Spell Levels, much like Power fuels Psionics.

- **Godfire:** The ultimate extension of *Dominion*. The power source used for major divine miracles.
- **Grandiose:** Items or creatures of vast size. These have their own size chart.
- **Hexcraft:** A spellcasting system based on cards.

- **(Int Mod):** Intelligence Bonus. Abbreviation.
- **Magic Level:** A magic level is one "level" of progression in any magical system using spell slots. These can be purchased directly.
- **Mana:** Generic power for all magic.
- **Martial Arts:** Combat skills which specialize your style (and an unrelated special ability).
- **Metamagical Theorem:** A general metamagical effect which can be applied in a wide variety of ways.
- **Microscale:** Creatures or things that are too small to see. Microscale creatures have their own size chart.
- **Mystic Artistry:** The use of art-related powers.
- **Path of the Dragon:** A system of arcane abilities based on personal mystical energy.
- **Power:** When capitalized, psionic energy.
- **Proficiencies:** Basic skills with armor and weapons.
- **Ritual Magic:** A freeform, if slow, technique for producing magical effects.
- **Rune Magic:** A magical technique relying on skills in specific magical fields.
- **SL:** Abbreviation of Spell Level. Mostly used for metamagic.
- **Skill Points (SP):** Skill Points are just Character Points spent on buying skills, or gained from Intelligence bonuses.
- **Specialized:** A very specific ability. *When capitalized, it refers to a feat modifier noted on page 22!*
- **(Str Mod):** Strength Bonus. Abbreviation.
- **Thaumaturgy:** A primal magical technique using raw energy and a specific theme.
- **Theurgy:** A spellcasting system based on magical nouns and verbs.
- **Traits:** Character personality values used to guide roleplaying in doubtful situations.
- **Warcraft:** A character's skill with all weapons and attacks (*i.e.*, BAB).
- **(Wis Mod):** Wisdom Bonus. Abbreviation.
- **Witchcraft:** A magical system reliant on low-level psychic powers.



Another character sheet, Sir?